Recruitment screening decision brief

Recommendation. Automate screening and first-round booking so qualified applicants reach interviews promptly and panels spend less time on unsuitable applicants. Reject confirmed mandatory-check failures and scores below the approved role threshold. For passing candidates, the agent looks up panel calendars, finds shared availability, offers slots and books the selected time automatically. Resolve missing inputs through WhatsApp or an SMS-linked page; escalate only unresolved, contested or required interventions.

Main issues

The customer receives **400,000 applications a year for 20,000 roles**. The process must address three issues:

1. Good profiles can be missed. Heavy screening workloads can favor familiar brands and resume keywords over evidence of the quality of work.

2. Good candidates can be lost. Delays in contacting candidates and scheduling first rounds give competing employers time to hire them.

3. Interview time is costly. Screening must protect panel time by keeping unsuitable applicants out of interviews.

Research context: Ladders reported a 7.4 second initial resume scan [1]; Cronofy found 42% had left a process over scheduling delays [2]. Validate the customer's screening errors and brand bias in the pilot.

Recruiter journey

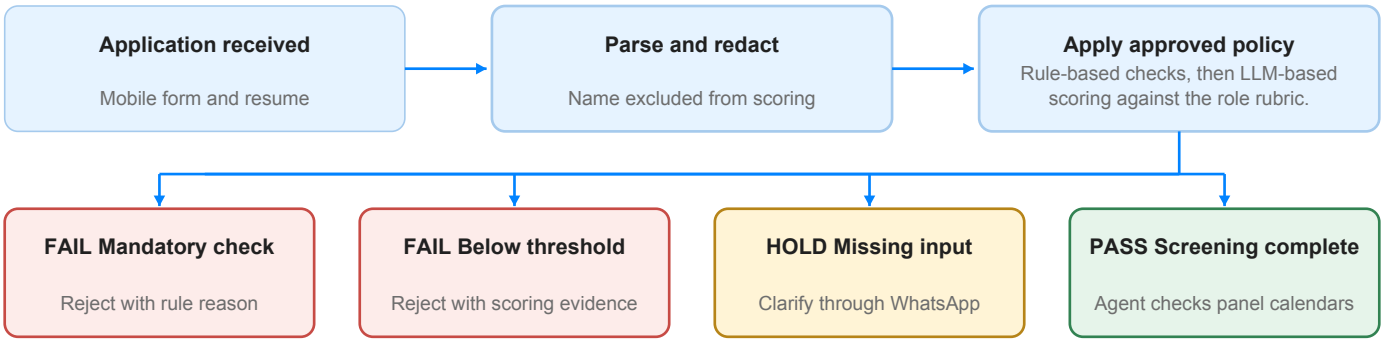
Open the requisition. The role defaults job-specific requirements (salary range and expectations, visa/work authorization, shift and location) and a job-matching rubric (criteria, weights and threshold). Review and modify defaults where enterprise permissions allow, then approve the version. Add the first-round panel members; the agent reads their calendars and books interviews. Monitor scores, rejection rates, outreach and bookings; handle escalations. On role closure, stop invitations and notify remaining applicants.

Applicant Journey

Apply on mobile, upload a resume and provide role requirements. Explicitly opt in for WhatsApp. Receive a decision or clarification within 48 hours. Use WhatsApp or an SMS link to a mobile page with the same journey: supply missing inputs, choose a slot or request alternatives, receive confirmation/reminders and reschedule. Request reasons or human review without an employee login.

Approach

After deterministic checks, rate warehouse shift manager evidence: **0 No evidence; 1 Limited evidence; 2 Clear evidence**. **Match score = 100 * sum(weight_fraction * rating / 2)**, rounded to two decimals. Reject below the job threshold (default 70; equality passes). Buckets: **Poor 0 to <50; Fair 50 to <70; Good 70 to <86; Excellent 86 to 100**. Use buckets only for high-volume priority; order by deadline within each.



Process applications in **12-hour batches by requisition**. At high volume, prioritize higher passing buckets, then applicants with the earliest original outreach deadline. This compares applicants before allocating scarce panel slots. Twelve hours is provisional, leaving up to 36 hours for follow-up within the **48-hour outreach limit**. Test intervals against booking quality, panel effort and SLA breaches. Preserve original deadlines. If calendars are full, keep passing applicants eligible while the agent finds alternatives.

Launch controls and success metrics

Success metrics and guardrails

North star. % of qualified applicants with a confirmed first-round interview booking **within 5 days of application.**

Time to book, not just reach out: own both scheduling coverage and speed. Measure receipt to booking confirmation.

Business

1. Time to first interview scheduled.
Days from application to confirmed booking.
2. Booking conversion.
% of genuinely qualified applicants booked within a defined observation window.
3. Human intervention rate.
% of applications needing manual screening or scheduling; exclude planned audits.

Performance & efficiency

1. Outreach within 48 hours.
Meaningful next step; exclude generic acknowledgements.
2. Applicant response rate.
% of contacted qualified applicants responding within 12 hours.
3. Cost per qualified booking.
Model, hosting, messaging and human exception costs / qualified bookings.
4. WhatsApp opt-in rate.
% of applicants shown the consent prompt who explicitly opt in.

Guardrails

1. Screening quality.
Independently audited false-negative and false-positive rates; fairness checks.
2. Booking reliability.
% without duplicates, conflicts, incorrect details or system-caused changes.
3. Candidate experience & accountability.
Complaints, opt-outs and unresolved exceptions.

Country approval and decision evidence

Employment counsel and the privacy lead approve each market: **India** hiring and privacy requirements; **US** federal, state and local hiring, accessibility and automated-tool duties; **Germany** GDPR, applicable EU AI Act duties and works council involvement. Confirm notices, data handling and candidate rights before launch.

Talent acquisition owns versioned rules and their job-related reasons. Redact names; decide further proxy controls during design. Keep evidence, policy/model/prompt versions, overrides, delivery and tool results with access and retention controls. Treat resumes as untrusted data; test injection and extraction failures.

Make LLM scoring robust before launch

Use role-specific anchored ratings and source-linked evidence; compute the weighted total deterministically. Test scoring stability, transferable experience, resume formatting, keyword stuffing and prompt injection. Use historical binary interview/no-interview labels. Manually review both LLM disagreement types and correct the evaluation set; historical bias can persist. Version the rubric, threshold, model and prompt; revalidate changes before activation.

Two month launch plan

WEEKS 01-02
Agree and baseline.

WEEKS 03-04
Build and integrate.

WEEKS 05-06
Shadow and evaluate.

WEEKS 07-08
Pilot and release.

Weeks 1-2: agree role policy, baseline metrics and country requirements. **Weeks 3-4:** build screening and booking; integrate WhatsApp and SMS scheduling links, consent and delivery tracking. **Weeks 5-6:** shadow-test scoring, channel retries and calendar conflicts. **Weeks 7-8:** pilot selected sites and release where gates pass. Pause harmful automation and retain a manual fallback.

Post-pilot optimization. Test message delivery at different local times of day to improve applicant response rates. Preserve the 48-hour outreach deadline and track five-day booking conversion alongside response rates.

[1] Ladders, 2018 eye-tracking study announcement. Source. [2] Cronofy, Candidate Expectations Report 2024; 12,000 respondents in seven countries, including the US and Germany, excluding India. Source. Both are vendor studies; validate local behavior in the pilot.